FLEXIPLE PRODUCT INTERN ASSIGNMENT · PRE-ALPHA PROTOTYPE

GCC Atlas — India’s GCC ecosystem, made searchable.

Provenance-first city, policy and company comparison for India capability-centre decisions: every number carries its source, its date, and its counting denominator.

WORKING TITLE — name collision flagged (S38)

COMPOSITES FROM EVIDENCE — NO INTERVIEWS CONDUCTED

GCCS (PARENT-LEVEL)	GCC UNITS	OF 2025 OFFICE ABSORPTION	GCC REVENUE FY26
2,117	3,728	39%	$98.4B
FY2026 · S01/S02	FY2026 · S01	CBRE · S20	Nasscom–Zinnov · S02

Prototype runs from the repo: `npm run setup && npm run seed && npm run dev:api` + `npm run dev:web` (full walkthrough: deployment/demo-walkthrough.md)

PROBLEM

The problem: fragmented intelligence, costly decisions

India’s GCC ecosystem is large, fast and definitionally messy — the decision layer above company directories is nowhere assembled.

GCCS PARENT-LEVEL FY2026

2,117

Nasscom–Zinnov · S01/S02

FY2026 REVENUE

$98.4B

same series · S02; 3 adds independent confirm

OF 2025 OFFICE-ABSORPTION IS GCCS

39%

CBRE leasing records · S20/S22

- **8+ state policies in 8+ formats.** Karnataka, TN, UP, Gujarat, Kerala… each publish subsidy tables in different shapes (payroll %, land subsidy, stamp duty, OPEX caps) — normalizing them is manual analyst work (S05–S19).
- **Counting regimes conflict.** 2,117 GCCs / $98.4B (Nasscom–Zinnov, S02) vs "$164B / 4.2M jobs" (Wizmatic via Statesman, S04 — low-confidence definitional outlier, registered as a conflict, never averaged).
- **The comparison is done by consultants on 3–6-week cycles.**A build-vs-lease decision uses brokerage PDFs + press releases + Excel (S01, S24); a defensible shortlist with citations can take weeks to assemble.
- **Source quality varies wildly.** DIY city directories contain row-level coding mistakes (GCC Village: ~473 Hyderabad vs ~100 Bengaluru rows, S35) that can misinform a location case.

Everything above is cited; no market-size figure on this slide is our own estimate.

STAKEHOLDERS (composite personas, evidence-based)

Who feels the information asymmetry

PRIMARY — designed for

Priya Raman

Location-strategy lead, MNC expansion desk

- Translates headcount mandate → city criteria
- Needs ranked prospects w/ talent + cost + subsidy facts
- Must defend the shortlist to CFO + consultants
- Fears "why is this number different?" in review

Basis: 64% of GCC space take-up by her class of buyer (S20,S21); UK/US firms drive 37–45% of India office absorption (S24). Composites; no interviews.

secondary — served

Rakesh

State investment-promotion (IPA) officer

- Competes vs peer states with numbers, not slogans
- Wants a shareable neutral page for prospects
- Fears third-party tables painting the state unfairly

Basis: 8+ states run GCC-acquisition playbooks with published targets (S05,S10,S13,S16). Secondary persona — distribution catalyst in v1.

secondary — served

Maya

Provider / enabler BD lead (RE, legal, staffing)

- Wants ready-to-engage demand signals
- Currently pays $3.5K–$10K for lead surfaces (S30)
- v1 gives her nothing to pay for — trust cultivated first

Basis: GCC Explorer monetizes exactly this class (S30); AIM watchlists purchased by this class (S32).

Anti-personas by design: job-seekers (no JTBD) and competitor scrapers. Everything persona-labelled as [inference] through Phase-3 validation gates.

COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE (verified, S30–S38)

Current workarounds and where they stop

GCC Explorer (AIM Research)

1,680+ GCC directory, daily analyst updates, contacts, watchlists. $3,500–$10,000 per seat cycle; free tier = 15 companies (S30/S31/S32).

Their gap: Not a city-DECISION tool: no policy-incentive normalization, no side-by-side compare with counting denominators (S30 pages reviewed).

Consultancies (CBRE/JLL/Zinnov)

Authoritative bespoke decks; mandates; human nuance (S01, S20–S24).

Their gap: Time + fees; 3–6 week cycles; not self-serve at session speed.

State portals + PIB PDFs

Primary-source truth; free (S05–S19).

Their gap: 8+ formats; conflicting denominators; normalization is analyst hours.

DIY directories (GCC Village et al.)

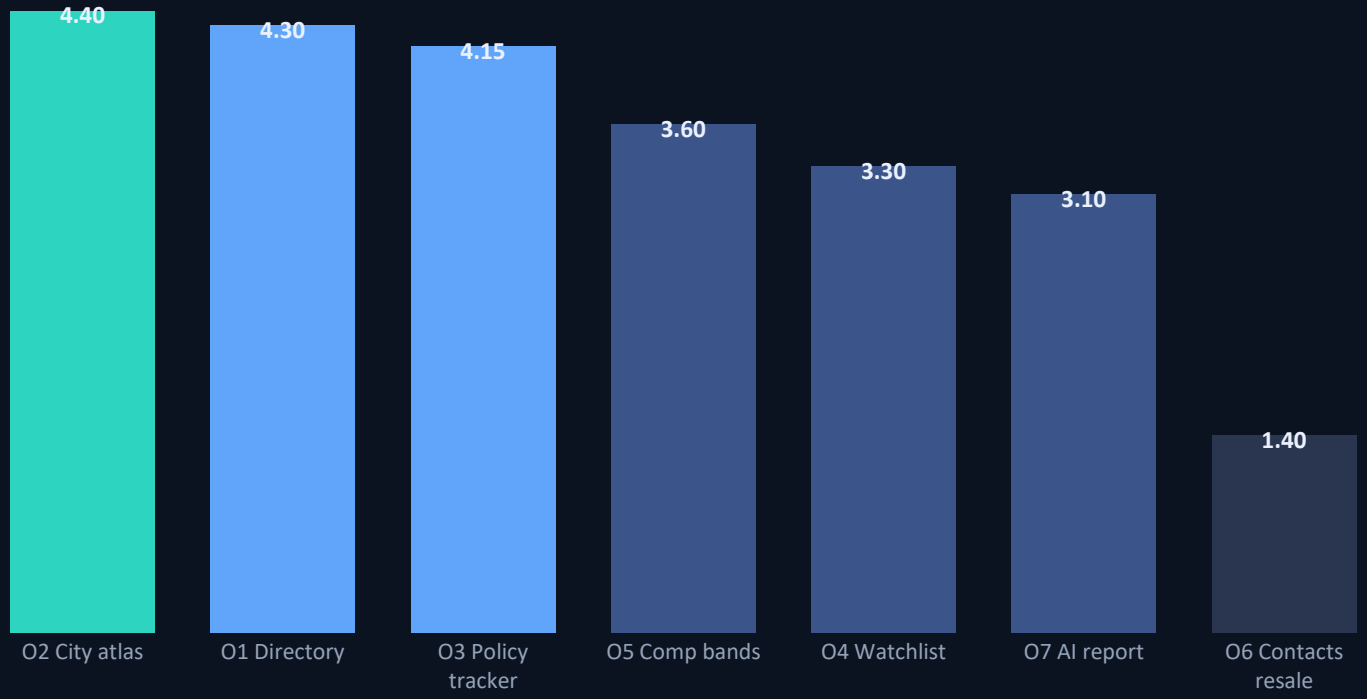
Free coverage slices (S35–S37).

Their gap: Row-level coding inconsistencies (S35); unverified; no provenance.

White space we occupy: a free, provenance-linked city-vs-city comparison layer with explicit counting denominators — no verified analog exists across the scanned landscape.

SCORING (research/opportunity-prioritization.md)

Opportunity map and prioritization



Scores = weighted TAM / underservedness / public-data feasibility / prototype fit / risk (weights 20/30/25/15/10). Method + rubric documented in research/opportunity-prioritization.md.

WINNER: O2 — the decision layer

- **City atlas + location-comparison** is the most underserved, most buildable surface (O2 score 4.40).
- **O1 directory and O3 policy tracker ship as** supporting modules inside it.
- **Deliberately excluded:** contact-data resale (O6: name/legal risk, S38), watchlists/O4 (needs live ingestion infrastructure), comp-band library (O5: licensing cost, Phase-3 candidate).
- **Falsification path:** if a real expansion desk says a one-week spreadsheet solves it, we pivot to O4 (documented in research §6).

PRIMARY SEGMENT

Initial target customer and the job to be done

Job statement (from primary persona)

"Compare candidate cities for a new GCC — talent, policies, real-estate cost and sector peers — for a specific function, with every number carrying its counting denominator and its source."

- **JTBD 1 — Frame:** mandate → city criteria (function, tier, cost ceiling).
- **JTBD 2 — Shortlist:** ranked candidates with facts (talent, rent, subsidy).
- **JTBD 3 — Defend:** comparison survives CFO + consultant scrutiny, cited.
- **JTBD 4 — Act:** know exactly which IPA contact / subsidy applies (TN 30/20/10% payroll bands S06; UP ₹20,000/fresher S10).

Why this segment first

- **Documented demand density:** US/global firms drove 37–45% of recent office absorption; this class pays for location intelligence (CBRE/JLL advisory hours, S20–S24; GCC Explorer $3.5K–$10K, S30).
- **Worst information-workflow fit:** 8+ policy formats + conflicting market counts = exactly the asymmetry documented in market-research §2–3.
- **Reachable for validation** via IPA relationships + expansion-team desks (both self-identify publicly) [inference].
- **Acceptance is measurable:** M1 time-to-answer metric is instrumentable end-to-end.

[inference] items bound for Phase-3 interviews

WHAT IS BUILT (running prototype)

The product and its differentiated value proposition

One line: evidence-first India GCC location intelligence — the decision layer above directories, below bespoke consulting ("free to look, defensible to reuse").

City Intelligence

12 tracked cities × 6+ metrics; side-by-side compare of 2–4 cities w/ metric definitions, units and EST flags.

dataset: tracked records only (scope-labelled)

Policy matrix

State incentives normalized vs source G.O.s; draft/final states distinct; "not yet tracked" ≠ 0 (Kerala dual targets co-labelled, S16 vs S18).

Provenance everywhere

46 GCC records, 36 sources; every figure → source chip → publisher, URL, pub date, verification date, confidence.

seed linter fails a build on sourceless values

Cited AI assistant

Retrieval-pack answers; only retrieved evidence may be cited; hallucinated ids stripped (tested); recommendations separated, basis-labelled; declines when evidence is thin.

demo mode composes deterministically without a key

Saved research + share

Session-scoped server-side persistence (cross-session isolation tested); share links; CSV export.

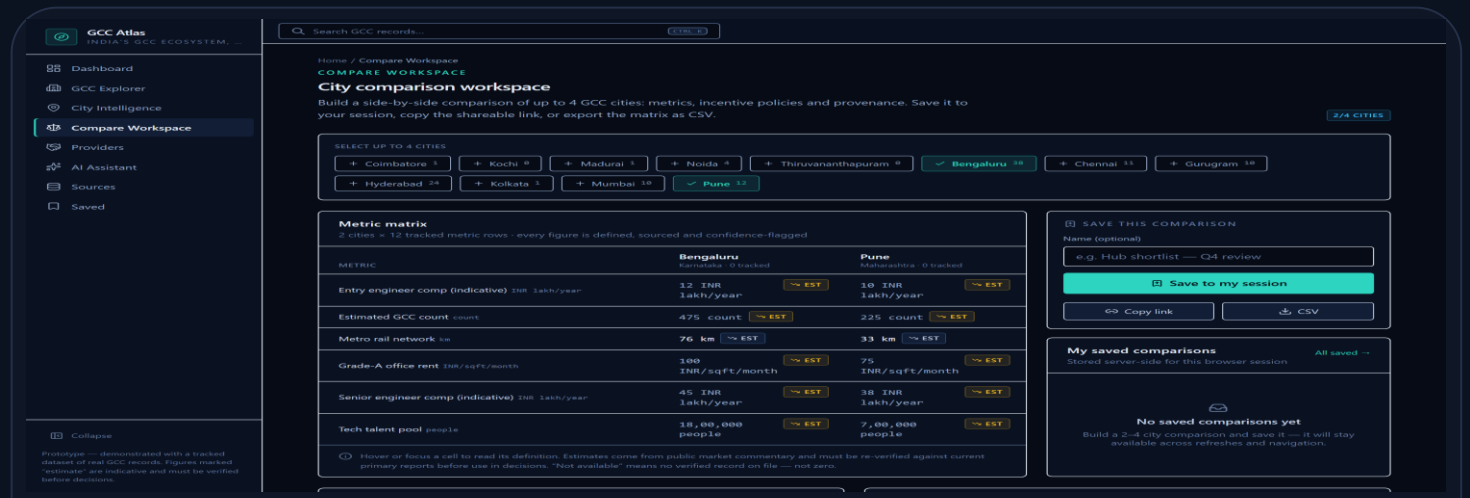
Event instrumentation

PRD §3.5 catalog (search, detail_view, compare_create, source_click, export, saved_create…) — hashed session keys; aggregate admin.

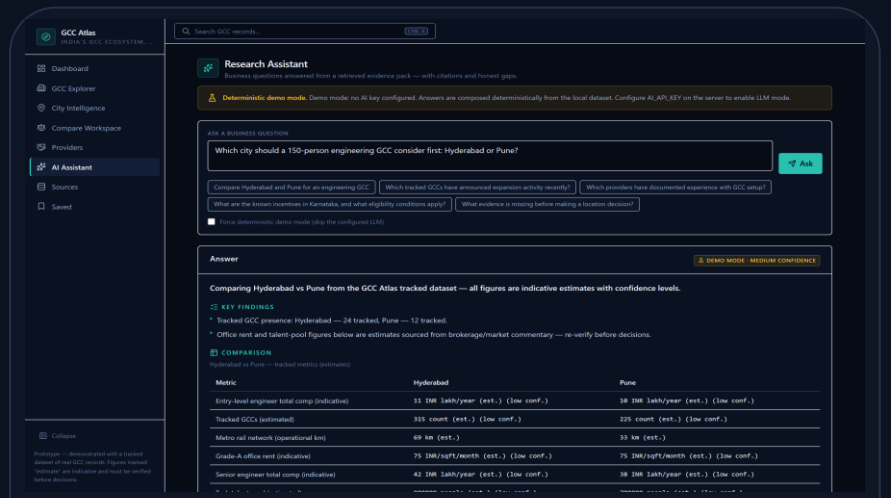
All coverage claims are dataset-scope-labelled; the app never claims the 2,117 national count as its own data.

SCREENSHOTS (headless-browser captures of the running build)

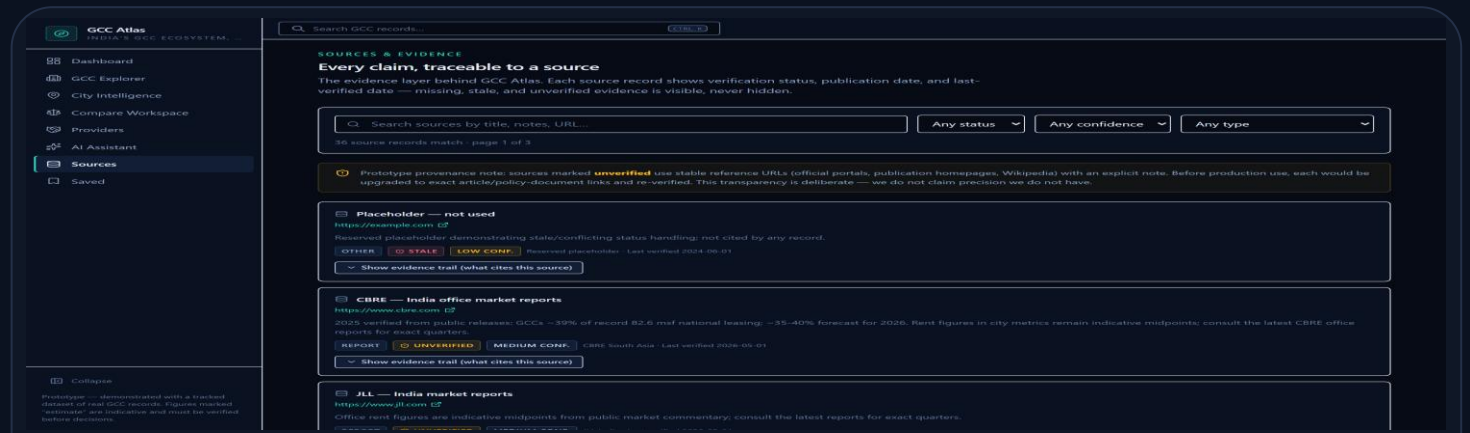
Product walkthrough — genuine prototype captures



Compare Workspace: Bengaluru vs Pune — EST flags, metric definitions, provenance chips, save/copy-link.



Assistant: structured, cited answer (demo mode).



Sources: publisher, confidence, verification date + reverse "where used" per source.



Dashboard: dataset-scope counters + verification ledger.

GO-TO-MARKET SEQUENCING [most steps are hypotheses]

Positioning and stakeholder adoption strategy

Category we aim to create: "evidence-first India GCC location intelligence" — decision layer above directories, below bespoke consulting. We never out-claim Nasscom–Zinnov/CBRE; their data is our source of record (competitive-landscape §4).

1. IPAs share

Free, cited compare links let state IPAs position themselves fairly vs peer states — they become our distribution catalysts (no engine gas needed, S05–S19; S12 shows IPAs actively pitch at NASSCOM events).

2. Providers inspect

Provider/BD leads verify claims pre-meeting (this class already pays $3.5K–$10K for similar surfaces, S30 — awareness follows the free tier).

3. Expansion desks adopt

Priya-style desks self-serve pre-work, arrive at consultant conversations evidence-armed; conversion to paid only AFTER free-tier trust (M1/M3 instrumented).

What we deliberately DON'T do: no paid ranking anywhere facts are shown (trust contract), no bulk contact-data resale (O6, name/legal risk S38), no interviews implied in any deck claim (Phase-3 validates all [inference] tags).

ALL PRICING = [proposal], UNVALIDATED

Business-model hypotheses and go-to-market

H1 · Free core (now)

City compare + policy matrix + source register stay free. Reputation density is the wedge; paying for data pre-trust kills it (business-model §1).

H2 · Pro seats [proposal]

$99–$199/yr individual; $500–$2,000/yr teams of 3–5 — anchored at 3–6% of the market compar's $3.5K–$10K cycles (S30). Gate: free-tier traction first.

H4 · Reports [proposal]

Free quarterly standard; $299–$499 thematic deep-dives once publishing muscle exists (market precedent: free quarterly exists S31; historic $9,999 static lists S33).

H5 · Provider verified [proposal]

$199–$499/yr verified-profile attributes only — zero influence on rankings/answers; banned-paid-ranking is a standing product rule (business-model §4).

GTM hypotheses [proposal, no spend]: content-catalyst loop (share links) + expansion-desk outreach + token funnel metrics (M3 search→detail ≥40%; M1 median <10 min — BOTH are unvalidated targets until Phase 3 instrumentation reports).

Data trust, AI reliability, risks and success metrics

Trust contract (enforced in code, not just values)

- **Every figure sourced:** seed linter FAILS the build on a sourceless value (F6); provenance chips on all numeric surfaces.
- **Denominators labelled:** "GCCs, parent vs units" named at every count (S01/S02-style conflict rendered, never averaged).
- **Conflicts co-shown:** $98.4B (S02) vs $164B (S04) both visible, flagged as contested.
- **Missing ≠ zero:** "not yet tracked", draft policies flagged; placeholder sources labelled "stale".
- **AI cites or declines:** only retrieved evidence citable; unknown citation ids stripped in tests; insufficiency is an honest low-confidence path; recommendations never blended into facts.

Risks + metrics (targets are [proposals])

- **Coverage honesty:** 46-company tracked subset; never billed as "all 2,117 GCCs" (S02/S30 context).
- **Name collision:** gcc-atlas.com exists (S38) — working-title label everywhere; trademark check is a Phase-3 gate.
- **Data freshness:** verify-by dates shown; manual re-verification pass scheduled at submission.

M1	Time-to-answer < 10 min [proposal]
M2	100% of displayed figures carry sources (hard invariant); assistant ≥95% answered w/ ≥1 citation [proposal]
M3	Search→detail ≥40% [proposal]
M4-M6	compare/assistant/provider engagement + no-paid-ranking guardrail countermetrics

PHASE GATES (product/roadmap.md)

Roadmap, prototype and next steps

Phase 2 — DONE: working prototype

- Research → strategy → full build (Phases 1–8)
- Retrieval→citation pipeline + demo fallback
- Rate limits, events, session ACL, QA report (94+14 tests green)
- Deployment guide + render.yaml + this deck

Phase 3 — validation loop

- 0→1 interviews to replace [inference] tags (5+ expansion desks, 2+ IPAs)
- Re-calibrate M1/M3 targets from real funnel data
- Trademark check (S38) → rename-or-keep decision

Phase 4 — paid options (gated)

- H2 seats only after free-traction gate; H3 workspaces; H5 provider profiles under neutrality rules
- Monitoring layer F17 if O2 survives falsification tests

The bet, honestly framed: the market is undeniably real and growing; the intelligence layer above it is fragmented and expensive; a discipline-first free comparator is buildable and differentiated. What we have NOT proven: demand (no interviews), willingness-to-pay (proposals only), and defensibility against a fast follower. Every one of those is instrumented to be falsifiable in Phase 3 — which is the point.

Prototype + demo script: deployment/demo-walkthrough.md · QA evidence: qa/quality-report.md · Full evidence register: research/source-register.csv · Deck sources: product/deck-evidence-sources.md